

Work like an art director

Multimedia 12 • plan, compare, test, revise and defend



Make choices against a brief.

Keep evidence of what changed and why.

TRY • 2 MIN Name a decision the designer must make before opening Photoshop.

A usable proposal

Write a specific, testable production intention.

PLAN	Premise + audience + product	Premise and intended audience.
TEST	Observable success check	Message, emotion and viewing context.
REVISE	Risk + fallback + next decision	Product, constraints and evidence of success.

TRY · 5 MIN Complete the one-page proposal using your own premise. Include one real risk and a fallback.

Research an image; do not copy its answer

References should inform a decision you can explain.



Saul Bass • 1955



A24 film still • 2016

Record maker, date, source and viewing context.

Identify a visible choice and the job it performs.

Distinguish observation, documented intention and interpretation.

TRY • 2 MIN Annotate two references, including one historical example. Explain one influence and one feature you will not copy.

Mood board, thumbnail and artboard

Three planning tools do different work.

Mood board	References + reasons for a direction
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Mood board: a visual direction and its reasons.

Thumbnail	Quick composition alternatives
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Thumbnail: a quick composition alternative.

Artboard	Defined production layout
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Artboard: a defined production layout in a document.

TRY · 2 MIN Identify which tool you need for colour direction, composition choice and comparing output formats.

Build a browser mood board

Use Excalidraw without installing software.

COLOUR ROLES



Cream / background / #f4ead5



Dark ink / main words / #193443



Terracotta / accent / #b85a36

Open excalidraw.com; add permitted study references.

Add five colour samples and two type-role examples.

Write a reason beside each reference; save the editable scene.

TRY • 10 MIN Make one compact board for your own premise. Include reasons and source links.

Three genuinely different directions

Change the composition or visual idea, then compare.



Image-led



Symbol-led



Type-led

Image-led: a principal subject tells the story.

Symbol-led: an object or metaphor carries the premise.

Type-led: the title's treatment carries meaning.

TRY • 6 MIN Sketch three small alternatives in 6 minutes; write the job of each.

Choose against the brief

Retain the rejected option and explain the trade-off.

COMPARE Communication + feasibility

Which direction communicates the premise?

CHOOSE Use evidence against the brief

Which is readable in the stated encounter?

REJECT Explain a real trade-off

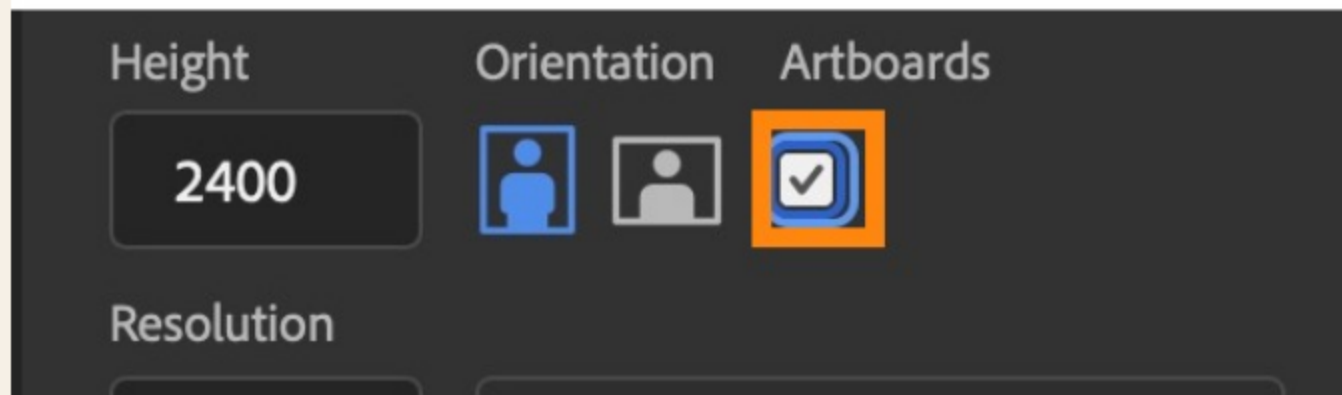
Which can you produce with permitted sources and taught methods?

TRY · 2 MIN Select one direction and reject another using two criteria and visible evidence.

Photoshop artboards

Keep alternative layouts organised in a single source.

Action 2.4 / genuine capture



Earlier New Document dialog; check the selected board's actual size

Select the Artboard tool, grouped with the Move tool.

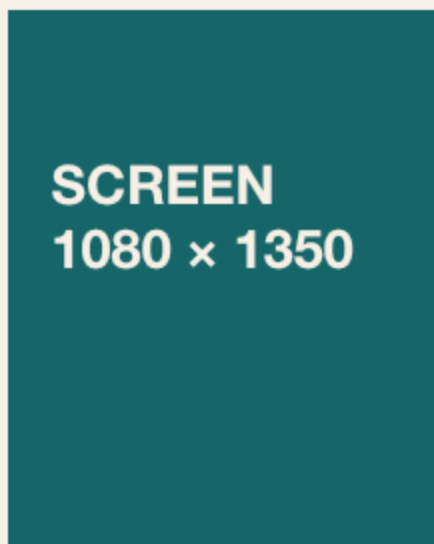
Set and check the required artboard dimensions.

Name each board and keep its layers inside its group.

TRY · 2 MIN Before placing artwork, identify where the selected artboard's dimensions are checked.

Dimensions are a production decision

Check the actual requirement before resampling.



Print master: 8.5 × 11 inches at 300 ppi = 2550 × 3300 pixels.

Optional screen study: 1080 × 1350 pixels.

A change of aspect ratio needs reflow, not stretching.

Different proportions; redesign the layout

TRY · 2 MIN Explain why resizing a 2550 × 3300 poster to 1080 × 1350 needs a layout check.

A viewer test that changes the design

Ask for evidence before explaining your intention.

SHOW	Intended viewing scale	Show the poster at its intended viewing size.
ASK	What was read and understood?	Ask what was noticed and what message was understood.
CHANGE	Revise one mismatch	Record the actual response; revise a specific mismatch.

TRY • 2 MIN Run the viewing test; record one response and one design consequence.

Source integrity and representation

Explain what you used and what you changed.

RECORD Maker + link + permitted use

Record image and font sources and permitted use.

SEPARATE Study reference / production asset

Distinguish study references from production assets.

DISCLOSE AI use + your editing decisions

Disclose AI use and your own editing decisions.

TRY • 2 MIN Add one source-log entry with creator, URL/origin, use basis and changes made.

Independent revision and defence

Show that the method is yours to use.

PREDICT

Respond to a taught change

Respond to a taught change in the director's brief.

REVISE

Show the source controls

Show the before/after and relevant source controls.

DEFEND

Decision → effect → evidence

Explain three decisions using evidence.

TRY · 2 MIN Practise a 60-second defence: choice → visible evidence → audience/purpose → trade-off.

Deliver a usable package

Name, reopen and check the actual files.

SOURCE	Layered editable PSD	Layered PSD and required viewing export.
EXPORT	Checked viewing image	Planning comparison, revision evidence and source log.
EVIDENCE	Plan + comparisons + credits	Short defence and completed final reflection.

TRY · 2 MIN Use the delivery checklist and resolve one failed check before submission.

The Grade 12 target

Original decisions, technical control and tested communication.

DECIDE	Compare alternatives	Interpret the brief and compare alternatives.
CREATE	Recoverable purposeful image	Create a recoverable, coherent image.
DEFEND	Test + revise + explain	Test, revise and defend with visible evidence.

TRY · 2 MIN Find one criterion where your current evidence is strong and one where evidence is still missing.

The later motion bridge

When the poster moves, time becomes another design variable.

0–2 sec	Establish the story cue	Decide order, duration and hold time.
2–4 sec	Reveal the title	Preserve reading and message in the moving version.
4–6 sec	Hold readable essentials	Use the later Make It Matter route for actual motion evidence.

TRY · 2 MIN On paper, predict which element should appear first and what must remain long enough to read.

Retrieve and return

Use the terms to diagnose another image.

RECALL	Explain without your notes
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TRANSFER	Apply to a fresh image
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RETURN	Revise your own decision
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Next class: explain mood board, thumbnail and artboard without notes.

After a delay: critique an unfamiliar layout.

Return to your proposal and identify the next production decision.

TRY · 2 MIN Write one distinction, one tested revision and one next step.